

“80% IT ‘slaves’ in Bangalore will lose jobs to AI in 3 years: Bengaluru insider reveals who will be spared and why”

— *Mint*, April 2, 2026

“Oracle layoffs: Bengaluru techie with 14 years’ experience becomes Uber driver, lives ‘stress-free’ on ₹43,000 passive income”

— *The Economic Times*, April 6, 2026

“Layoffs, AI, rising cost of living: Why Bengaluru’s techies are feeling insecure”

— *Deccan Herald*, May 3, 2026

“AI, layoffs and the demand trap: The prisoner’s dilemma facing corporate India”

— *The Times of India*, July 1, 2026

“‘Developers are dime a dozen in Bangalore’: Firm asks techie to layoff 45 colleagues”

— *Hindustan Times*, June 18, 2026

Fig. 1: Some news reports showing the hard reality. It is no longer a question whether AI is replacing human workers

This too shall pass

Let us not pretend this phase does not hurt.

It does.

The shock, the scramble, the financial stress, the EMIs, the loans, the obligations, the rent, and the sleepless nights are painful, exhausting, and emotionally draining. They test you. It will hurt, but this too shall pass. Stay strong. What matters most is what comes after this, because that stretch of your life may be much longer than this difficult phase, and it is still entirely yours.

So, before you do anything else, ask yourself one useful question: What was the downside of the job you just lost? Maybe losing it might actually help you explore uncharted territory and discover more of your potential. Maybe it is an opportunity to look beyond that job. Sometimes not getting what we want can become an opportunity to find something even better. Maybe you will discover opportunities you had never considered.

Perhaps this setback is pushing you to do what you always wanted to do but never had the chance or courage to pursue because of the comfort of the job you had. Maybe greater things are waiting for you.

If you are a recent graduate, or

about to graduate, you still have time to rethink your options. Maybe it is time for some course correction. You may want to acquire different skills or choose different electives to stay relevant in the changing job market. The important thing is that not all is lost. You simply have to look again at your options instead of following the pre-set path you had been following until now.

You already proved yourself

Here is something worth remembering. It was you who got that job in the first place. It was you who walked into those interviews and passed them, meeting the standards someone else had set and competing against other candidates. Nobody handed you that seat out of pity. You earned it. Whatever it took to earn it is still inside you today.

If you had what it took then, you have what it takes now. Possibly more, because you have now been through something you had never faced before, and that experience itself is valuable.

Yes, it came suddenly. It may have caught you unprepared. But this is a short phase in a long life. Maybe next time you will be better prepared. Maybe you will value what you have differently. Maybe

this will become the reason you finally focus on becoming more valuable rather than merely more comfortable. That is not a consolation prize. It is a lesson, and lessons are often worth more than the comfort they cost to learn.

Take your time. Think deeply

Do not rush into the first job title or business plan someone hands you. Give yourself real time to think. Talk to people who lift you up, not the ones who catastrophise with you over chai. Let your own thoughts settle before you act on someone else’s idea of what you should do next.

And ask yourself the question most of us stop asking somewhere in our twenties: What do you actually like doing? Not what pays the most. What would you choose to spend a full day on, even if nobody was watching or applauding? Take days to answer that question. It is an important one. Write it down, literally, on a piece of paper. State why you like it. Once you like something deeply, you will look forward to doing it. If you do it all the time, you excel at it. Once you excel at it, your services or products become far superior for users. If your services or products are far superior to others, you can charge a fee, or even a premium fee. If you can charge a fee for your services or products, you just found a way to convert your liking into a financial source.

Bring your expenses down first

Cash runway, not career strategy, comes first. The single most useful thing you can do right now is to bring your expenses down, way down, to the absolute minimum. There is no shame in that. Reduce your spending so your savings can stretch your runway. That gives you the freedom to take a calculated risk instead of a desperate one.

Lean on trust. Family, old colleagues, your local community—this